

When Dining Tables Tell Stories

THE ONCE-HUMBLE DINING TABLE HAS EVOLVED INTO A CANVAS FOR STORYTELLING

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

IN HOMES ACROSS India, dinner has become theatre. Plates gleam under soft candlelight, crystal glasses catch the shimmer of brass votives, and napkins are folded like origami. The food matters, yes—but it is no longer the star. The table is.

What began as a niche hobby among global design influencers has turned into a full-fledged aesthetic movement in the country: tablescaping. The term, coined by American television chef Sandra Lee in

2003—a blend of “table” and “landscaping”—refers to the art of styling a table to tell a story. It’s a visual symphony of crockery, linen, florals, and décor that aims to evoke a mood, not just serve a meal.

“Tablescaping is all about storytelling,” says food and beverage curator Eeshaan Kashyap, whose label Tablescape by Eeshaan has quietly redefined the genre in India. “It blows my mind how it’s now a category of its own—people are gifting, entertaining, buying just for their tables. They want small plates, sculptural candles-



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